

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 287

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Omar Ernest "Ernie" Bacon, Jr., of Franklin.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Omar Ernest "Ernie" Bacon, Jr., of Franklin; and

WHEREAS, Ernie Bacon was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Chattanooga on May 9, 1937, Mr. Bacon was the son of Omar Ernest "O.E." Bacon, Jr., and Mary Elizabeth Sutton Bacon; and

WHEREAS, Ernie Bacon was a graduate of Tyner High School, and at the age of seventeen, he enlisted in the United States Naval Reserve and proudly served his nation for eight years; and

WHEREAS, he attended the University of Tennessee, where he served as the senior class president, a member of the 4-H Club, and a member of the Zeta Chapter of Pi Kappa Alpha; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bacon obtained his Master of Hospital Administration degree from the Medical College of Virginia and enjoyed a fruitful career in hospital administration and healthcare management; and

WHEREAS, he earned a Doctor of Pharmacy degree from the University of Tennessee in Memphis, where he met his wife, Nell, and was a member of Kappa Psi Pharmaceutical Fraternity and Rho Chi Academic Honor Society in Pharmacy; and

WHEREAS, Ernie Bacon and his wife were the first pharmacists to work at the Moccasin Bend Psychiatric Hospital; he served as president of the Georgia Hospital Association and

chairman of the Southeastern Hospital Association and had residencies throughout Georgia, South Carolina, and Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, following his retirement from his position as senior vice president and chief operating officer of Community Health Systems, Mr. Bacon conducted independent consulting for numerous companies and hospitals and used his business background for long-term service as an Independence Trust Company board member; and

WHEREAS, Ernie Bacon was a published author on healthcare ethics and management and an adjunct professor for several colleges, such as Virginia Commonwealth, Georgia State, University of Alabama-Birmingham, and Washington University; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bacon was a history enthusiast and an active part of Civil War and historic preservation endeavors; he served as a founding member and president of Franklin's Charge; board member, vice chair, and treasurer of the Tennessee Preservation Trust; past chair of the Historic Carnton Plantation and the Heritage Foundation of Franklin and Williamson County; initial member and vice chair of the City of Franklin Battlefield Commission; and board member of the Tennessee Civil War Preservation Association, the Battle of Franklin Trust, and the Tennessee Civil War National Heritage Area; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bacon was twice elected as an Alderman of the City of Franklin, a position he held from 1999 to 2007, and during that time, he founded Franklin Tomorrow, Franklin Sister Cities, and Franklin Transit Authority; and

WHEREAS, he was appointed as chairman of the Hamilton County School Board by the Hamilton County Quarterly Court, and during his tenure, he served as the youngest school board member in Tennessee; additionally, former Governor Bill Haslam appointed him to the Tennessee Historical Commission in 2015; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Ernie Bacon received the Bob Ragsdale Award from the Tennessee Civil War Preservation Association, the Anne T.

Rutherford Exemplary Community Volunteer Award, and the SAGE Award from the Council of Aging of Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, perhaps his greatest contributions as a public official were collaborating alongside Dr. Thomas Frist, Sr., and Minnie Pearl in creating the Sarah Cannon Cancer Center; developing future hospital executives; and developing three public parks, including Harlinsdale Farm, Eastern Flank Battlefield, and Carter Hill Battlefield Park; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bacon was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his beloved wife of sixty-six years, Nell Crawford Bacon; his children, Lisa Dawn Bacon (Clay) Hackney and Steven Ernest (LaDonna) Bacon; his grandchildren, Julia Louise Hackney (Mitch) Cagle, Amanda Erin Hackney (Charles) Thomas, and Jackson Ross Bacon; his great-grandchildren, Hayden Michael Cagle, Leah Anderson Cagle, Charlotte Nell Cagle, Charles Broadrick Thomas, and Erin Rose Thomas; his siblings, Marialice Baker and Ellis Sutton Bacon; and several nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, Ernie and Nell Bacon were proud residents of Fourth Avenue South for more than thirty years, welcoming their neighbors and the community into their home, known as the Bacon-Campbell House, and featuring their home on several home tours; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bacon was also wholly devoted to his faith and attended Franklin First United Methodist Church with his family; and

WHEREAS, Ernie Bacon leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Omar Ernest "Ernie" Bacon, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Bacon.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.